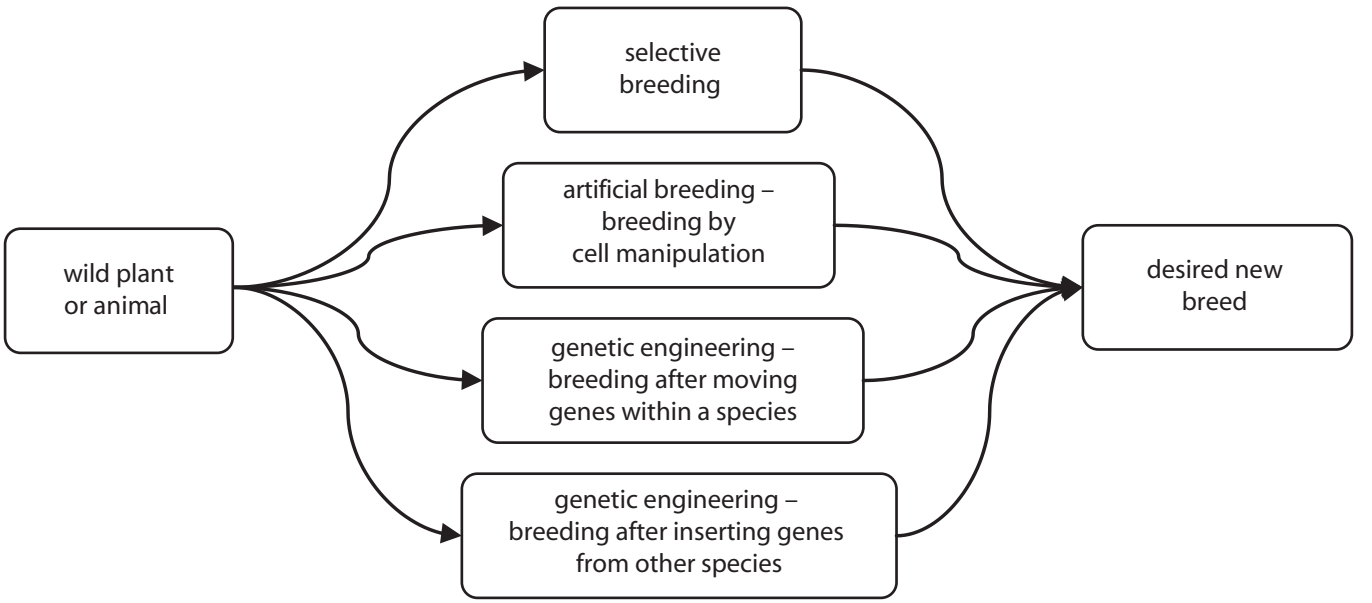
Selective breeding

Selective breeding means that a human controls which plants **reproduce** or which animals have **offspring**. The human chooses parent plants or animals with desirable features and avoids those with unwanted features. New techniques in selective breeding have been introduced over the last 60 years.



1 Circle the correct word in each pair to complete the passages below.

Selective breeding

It used to take farmers years to breed animals and plants to get [better/poorer] quality or larger **yields**. The result may have been a [smarter/fatter] sheep dog, a woollier sheep, [less/more] milk from cows, or a higher wheat yield to make more and [mouldy/better] flour.

Artificial breeding

Now [new/old] crop or animal breeds can be produced quickly [while/without] waiting for individuals to reach breeding age. Scientists can manipulate cells by fertilising [eggs/paddocks] and implanting them in the mother or [weeding/growing] plants from seeds in a laboratory.

Genetic engineering

After being removed from the mother, while the eggs of a plant or animal are [outside/beside] the mother, different nuclei or genes can be [invented/inserted]. They may come from the same [cow/species] or from different species. [Genes/Chemicals] can be added to produce certain qualities, such as insect resistance.

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